

# **Sigma Omega Nu Latina Interest Sorority, Inc.**

## **Chapter Standards**

### **Mission Statement**

“Sigma Omega Nu’s foundation was built on academics, cultura, and sisterhood. Some objectives are to strengthen cultural, personal and educational goals while promoting moral, academic and family support. Through mutual support and encouragement, Sigma Omega Nu instills the importance of education and academic success in the college environment.”

All members of Sigma Omega Nu strive to uphold the principles of the Sorority’s Mission Statement. It is also a requirement of each Chapter to promote and encourage these principles. The Chapter Standards program was created to help guide the Chapters towards positive and continued development and improvement.

### **Annual Submittal & Review:**

Chapter Standards shall be submitted annually and are due no later than June 30th. Each submission must document Chapter activity from July 1st of the previous year through June 30th of the current year. All Chapter Standards documents must be uploaded to the designated National Google Drive Folder by the June 30th deadline. Only Chapters that submit their Chapter Standards by June 30th will be eligible for Chapter of the Year recognition.

Any Chapter that fails to submit its Chapter Standards by June 30th will be considered late and subject to the following consequences:

- **Submissions received between July 1st and July 15th**

Chapters that submit their Chapter Standards binder between July 1st and July 15th will be placed on Probation for the following academic term, regardless of the final score or rating earned.

- **Submissions not received by July 15th**

Chapters that fail to submit their Chapter Standards binder by July 15th will be placed on Suspension for the following academic term. Suspension imposed due to failure to submit by this deadline will not be eligible to be lifted, regardless of points earned upon eventual submission.

Submissions must consist only of the required forms and spreadsheets specified in the Chapter Standards credit requirements. All documents must be converted to PDF format and clearly labeled with the corresponding Section and Number. Materials submitted in an incorrect format, improperly labeled, or not explicitly required will not be reviewed and will not receive credit.

The National Board will review each Chapter’s submission collectively, and assign a final score and rating in accordance with the established scoring system. Final scores, written feedback, and the Chapter’s official status will be issued via email to all Chapters no later than August 30th. Feedback will identify areas for

improvement for the upcoming academic year.

Chapters receiving a rating of Probation or Suspension will be issued a formal Improvement Plan outlining required corrective actions for the following academic term. Chapters that fail to meet the requirements of their Improvement Plan will be placed on Suspension (if previously on Probation) or will remain on Suspension for the remainder of the academic year.

## **Points & Ratings**

The Chapter Standards are organized based on a point system. Points are given for the successful completion of a credit. The point system breakdown is as follows:

### **Obligatory: 50 points**

The Obligatory credits are required to be completed by every Chapter each year in order to be recognized as a Chapter of Sigma Omega Nu. Most of the Obligatory credits are for the Chapter's commitments to the National Board. Any Chapter that does not complete all Obligatory requirements is automatically placed on Suspension, regardless of overall points earned.

### **Required: 20 points**

In addition to the Obligatory credits, the Required credits are considered the basic foundation for the successful running of a Chapter.

### **Expected: 10 points**

Expected credits are required activities that support the continued growth, development, and sustainability of the Chapter.

### **Additional: 5 points**

Additional credits are given for events or activities above and beyond what is required of the Chapter or its members.

Once the points are totaled, they are to be graded as follows:

**Obligatory is worth 50% of the total points**

**Required is worth 30% of the total points**

**Expected is worth 15% of the total points**

**Additional is worth 5% of the total points**

Each submittal will be reviewed and ranked based on what is submitted. Each Chapter will be rated in to one of the following categories:

### **Good: 85% or higher**

All Chapters should strive for Good Standing. A Chapter in Good Standing meets all the requirements of a successful Chapter and will have little oversight from the National Board during the following year.

### **Acceptable: 75-84.99%**

The Chapter has demonstrated that it can complete the majority of the requirements of a successful Chapter but still has room to improve. A Chapter in Acceptable Standing will receive an occasional

review by the National Board to ensure that they are progressing.

**Probation: 65-74.99%**

Chapters that earn a Probation rating are subject to more periodic reviews by the National Board and the suspension of some rights, as determined by the National Board based on the Chapter's individual situation. An Improvement Plan will be developed by the National Board identifying areas of improvement and suggestions on how to improve.

**Suspension: 64.99% or below**

A monthly review by the National Board will be required. Any Chapter that falls into this rating is automatically prohibited from pledging a new class until substantial progress is shown.

Any Chapter that does not complete all Obligatory requirements is automatically placed on Suspension, regardless of overall points earned.

## **Section A. Campus Recognition**

If the University does not recognize Greek Life, and credits 1 through 3 of this section do not apply, a single letter on Sigma Omega Nu Official Letterhead explaining why the Chapter does not meet these requirements may be submitted.

- 1. University Recognition [Required].** The Chapter must be recognized as a student club or organization by the University.

Documentation: A copy of the Chapter charter as is on file with the student life office. Your University may call this a Club Charter, Officer Agreement, or something similar. If the University does not recognize Greek life, a letter on Sigma Omega Nu Official Letterhead explaining why the Chapter does not meet this requirement must be submitted.

- 2. Council Recognition [Required].** The Chapter must be a recognized Member Chapter with the appropriate Greek council and meet all requirements of council membership. If the Chapter is considered a Provisional, Associate or Probationary Chapter, the Chapter must be working towards becoming a full Member Chapter.

Documentation: A signed letter from the council advisor on University letterhead identifying the status and/or progress of the Chapter. If the Chapter is working towards becoming a full member chapter of the council, the letter must include a description of the membership requirements and the Chapter's progress towards becoming a full member chapter. If the Chapter is on Probation for any reason (such as academic or judicial), the letter must include the reasons for probation and the Chapter's progress towards returning to good standing. If the council does not have an advisor, then the letter must be from the council president. If the University does not have a recognized Greek Council, the letter must be on Sigma Omega Nu Official Letterhead explaining why the Chapter does not meet this requirement.

- 3. Recognition Workshop [Required].** Any officers required to attend any workshops or retreats for the recognition of the Chapter must attend said workshops or retreats as required.

Documentation: Use the Event Report form signed by Greek Life advisor, not a Chapter officer. If the University does not recognize Greek life, provide a letter on Sigma Omega Nu Official

Letterhead explaining why the Chapter does not meet this requirement.

- 4. Chapter Advisor [Required].** The Chapter must have an advisor who is a member of the faculty or staff of the University. If the Chapter is unable to find a suitable member of the University faculty or staff, a member of the local professional community may be chosen.

Documentation: Name, position/title, email, phone number and office address must be submitted on Sigma Omega Nu Official Letterhead.

## **Section B. Academics**

See the file “Academics.xls” for the spreadsheets referenced in this section.

- 1. Grade Reports [Required].** All undergraduate members are required to maintain a minimum 2.3 quarter/semester GPA and a minimum 2.5 cumulative GPA. The Chapter must submit the quarter/semester GPA and cumulative GPA for all Chapter members currently enrolled at the University; this includes all Active, Inactive, and Active Alumnae enrolled at the University. Active Alumnae must be included on the report; however, a GPA is not required to be listed if not enrolled. The Chapter must maintain a minimum 2.5 cumulative Chapter GPA (undergraduate membership only).

Documentation: Submit the official Member GPA Spreadsheet. “Status” reflects each member’s status at the start of the quarter/semester. GPAs must reflect those earned at the end of the quarter/semester. A separate spreadsheet must be submitted for each quarter or semester. Summer term reporting is not required. Each spreadsheet must be signed by the Chapter Vice President.

- 2. Mentorship Program [Required].** The Chapter must implement the Mentorship Program for any undergraduate Active or Inactive member whose academic performance falls below either of the following: a 2.3 quarter/semester GPA or a 2.5 cumulative GPA. Placement in the Mentorship Program is mandatory for the academic term immediately following the term in which the deficiency occurs. A member must remain in the Mentorship Program until both minimum GPA requirements are met.

Summer sessions are not monitored academic terms. If a member falls below the 2.3 quarter/semester GPA requirement at the conclusion of the Spring term, they must be placed in the Mentorship Program for the Fall term, regardless of Summer enrollment or Summer term GPA. If a member falls below the 2.5 cumulative GPA requirement at the conclusion of the Spring term, Summer coursework may be used to raise their cumulative GPA prior to the start of the Fall term. To qualify for removal from Mentorship based on cumulative GPA, the member must provide the Chapter Vice President updated grade documentation demonstrating that their cumulative GPA meets or exceeds 2.5. Summer term GPA may not be used to satisfy the 2.3 quarter/semester GPA requirement.

Documentation: Submit the official Mentorship Program Spreadsheet for each monitored quarter or semester. A separate spreadsheet must be submitted for each term. Summer sessions are not required submissions.

If no members qualify for the Mentorship Program during a monitored academic term, the Chapter

must submit a signed letter (on Sigma Omega Nu Official Letterhead) from the Chapter Vice President certifying that no undergraduate Active or Inactive members fell below the minimum GPA requirements for that term.

If a member is removed from the Mentorship Program prior to the Fall term due to their Summer cumulative GPA, the Chapter Vice President must submit a signed letter (on Sigma Omega Nu Official Letterhead) certifying that the member's updated cumulative GPA meets or exceeds 2.5, and verification of the updated cumulative GPA (unofficial transcript).

All spreadsheets and letters required under this section must be signed by the Chapter Vice President.

- 3. Alpha Order [Required].** The Chapter is required to recognize those members who have achieved a 3.0 cumulative GPA or higher each quarter or semester. Each year, the Sister with the highest cumulative GPA must be recognized with the Alpha Order plaque and the SON Scholarship.

Documentation: Submit the Alpha Order spreadsheet, signed by the Chapter Vice President. Only one spreadsheet listing all members for each quarter or semester is required. Summer quarter/semester is not required.

The Alpha Order Plaque & SON Scholarship recipient must be clearly identified on the spreadsheet. If no scholarship is awarded, the Chapter must indicate "\$0" in the scholarship field on the spreadsheet.

- 4. Study Hours [Required].** The Active members of the Chapter must complete a minimum of 6 documented study hours each week, or the minimum number of hours as determined by the Chapter. A minimum of 80% of members must complete all study hours each quarter/semester.

Documentation: Submit the official Study Hours spreadsheet. One spreadsheet must be used for each quarter or semester. Summer quarter/semester is not required. Each sheet must be signed by the Chapter Vice President.

- 5. Professional Development [Expected].** At minimum 80% of the Active members must attend a professional development presentation, workshop, or event each quarter or semester. Examples include, but are not limited to: time management workshops, graduate school preparation sessions, professional licensing preparation workshops, résumé or interview workshops, and career fairs. Members may attend different events within the same quarter or semester in order for the Chapter to meet the 80% attendance requirement.

Documentation: Submit the official Professional Development spreadsheet, signed by the Chapter Vice President. If multiple events are used to meet the 80% attendance requirement within a single quarter or semester, a separate spreadsheet must be submitted for each event attended. Attendance totals across submitted spreadsheets must clearly demonstrate that at minimum 80% of Active members participated in an event during that term.

- 6. Inactive Study Hours [Additional].** The Inactive members of the Chapter must complete a minimum of 6 documented study hours each week, or the minimum number of hours as determined

by the Chapter. A minimum of 80% of Inactive members must complete all study hours each quarter/semester.

Documentation: Use the official Inactive Study Hours spreadsheet. One sheet must be used for each quarter or semester. Summer quarter/semester is not required. Each sheet must be signed by the Chapter Vice President.

## **Section C. Cultura**

See the file “Cultura.xls” for the spreadsheets referenced in this section.

- 1. Annual Chapter Event [Required].** Each Chapter must host an annual event that promotes academic advancement or cultural awareness. If the Chapter hosts an academic/professional event, the event must promote academic and/or professional development and growth. If the Chapter hosts a cultural event, the event must promote Latino culture and/or the cultural backgrounds represented within the Chapter’s Active membership. The event must be open to the University community and/or the surrounding community and must provide a measurable benefit to attendees. Events primarily social in nature, including club parties or events involving alcohol, do not qualify toward this requirement. Only one event per academic year may be counted toward this requirement.

Documentation: Submit the official Event Report form signed by the Event Chair.

- 2. Parents’ & Families’ Banquet [Required].** Each Chapter must host an annual informational event for the parents and families of all Sigma Omega Nu members. The event may be conducted in-person, virtually, or in a hybrid format. The event must include a formal presentation covering the history of Sigma Omega Nu, the history of the Chapter, the mission and purpose of the sorority, and the Chapter’s recent accomplishments and activities. The event is intended to educate and engage families. A purely social gathering does not satisfy this requirement. The Parents’ & Families’ Banquet may be held in conjunction with the Chapter Formal or Anniversary Celebration, provided the required informational presentation is clearly included as a structured component of the program. Only one event per academic year may be counted toward this requirement.

Documentation: Submit the official Event Report form signed by the event Chair. If this event is done in combination with the Chapter Formal or Anniversary Celebration, this must be clearly stated on the Event Report form.

- 3. Community Service [Required].** Each Active and Active Alumnae member must complete a minimum of 30 community service hours per academic year. Of the required 30 hours: at minimum 10 hours must support the Chapter’s designated Philanthropy; and at minimum 10 hours must raise awareness for and support survivors of sexual assault through an established organization (i.e., tabling, collaborating, volunteering, or advocacy). If the Chapter’s Philanthropy aligns with supporting survivors of sexual assault, members may apply all 20 required hours toward the Chapter Philanthropy.

**New Member Proration:** For newly initiated members, the annual requirement will be prorated based on the number of full academic terms remaining in the academic year after initiation (10 hours per full quarter or 15 hours per full semester). If a member is initiated after the midpoint of a quarter

or semester, community service hours for that term are not required, and the requirement will begin the following full academic term. Prorated members must still complete proportional philanthropy and survivor support hours within their adjusted total requirement.

The following do not count towards service hours: class requirements, political campaigning, unpaid work for a business, babysitting, charitable donations, or paid service. Tabling and transportation of donated items do count as service hours.

Documentation: Use the official Community Service spreadsheet. Philanthropy hours are to be designated by a “P” and Awareness hours are to be designated by an “A”. One sheet must be used for each quarter or semester. Hours must be organized by scroll number, not by event. Summer quarter/semester is not required. Each sheet must be signed by the Commissioner of Community Service.

4. **Community Service Recognition [Required].** The member who completes the highest number of community service hours each monitored quarter or semester, and the member who completes the highest number of community service hours for the academic year, must be formally recognized. Recognition must occur during an official Chapter meeting and/or at a formal Chapter event (i.e., Parents’ & Families’ Banquet, Formal, Anniversary Celebration, or similar Chapter-sponsored celebration).

Documentation: The Members being recognized must be noted on the Community Service Spreadsheet. The date of recognition must also be noted.

5. **Philanthropy [Required].** Each Chapter must organize a minimum of one event each year with the purpose of raising money specifically for the Chapter Philanthropy.

Documentation: Use the official Event Report form signed by the Commissioner of Community Service. Indicate the amount of money raised and donated.

6. **Community Service Make-Up [Expected].** The Commissioner of Community Service must calculate total hours at the conclusion of each academic term and at the end of the academic year. If a member does not meet the minimum required hours by the end of the Fall term, the remaining hours must roll over and must be completed by the end of the Winter or Spring term within the same academic year. No formal make-up projects are required for Fall deficiencies unless the member remains deficient at the end of the academic year. If a member fails to complete the full annual service requirement by the conclusion of the Spring term, they must be placed on Community Service Make-Up status for the following academic term.

The member must complete a make-up project that directly benefits the Chapter. The project must be approved by the Commissioner of Community Service prior to implementation, have a clearly defined scope and deadline, and be completed by the end of the following quarter or semester. The make-up project does not replace the member’s ongoing service requirement for the new academic term. If the make-up project is not completed by the deadline, the member must complete an additional 10 study hours by the end of the following quarter/semester.

Documentation: Submit the Community Service Make Up spreadsheet, signed by the Commissioner

of Community Service. The spreadsheet must include the member's name, number of deficient hours, whether the deficiency is an in-year rollover or end of year deficiency, approved make-up project, deadline and completion status.

- 7. Cultural Engagement Events [Additional].** The Chapter is encouraged to attend culturally based events each quarter or semester. Events may be sponsored by a University entity (i.e., Multicultural Center, Women's Center, LGBTQIA+ Center, Ethnic Studies Department, Latinx faculty/staff association, or similar office) or hosted by a recognized cultural Greek organization, cultural student organization, or community-based cultural organization. The event must promote cultural awareness, education, or engagement aligned with the values of Sigma Omega Nu.

To receive credit, a minimum of five (5) Active Members or 25% of the Active Members (whichever is fewer) must attend the event.

Documentation: Use the official Event Report form, signed by the Chapter Commissioner of Cultura & Sisterhood. A maximum of 4 events per year may be submitted. Five points will be given for each event, not to exceed 20 points.

## **Section D. Sisterhood**

See the file "Sisterhood.xls" for the spreadsheets referenced in this section.

- 1. Battle of the Chapters [Obligatory].** A minimum of 80% of Chapter Actives are required to attend the annual Battle of the Chapters event. If a Letter of Excuse is submitted by the Chapter and passed by the National Board, the Chapter will not receive points for this credit, but will not be automatically placed on Suspension.

Documentation: Verification will be provided by the National Vice President of Parliament. Nothing is required to be submitted by the Chapter.

- 2. Chapter Roster [Required].** An updated Chapter roster must be on file with the National Vice President of Communications. This must be done after each Pinning, Crossover, graduation, change in officers, and at any other time required by the National Vice President of Communications.

Documentation: Verification will be provided by the National Vice President of Communications. Nothing is required to be submitted by the Chapter.

- 3. Chapter Anniversary Celebration [Required].** Each year, the Chapter must celebrate its establishment anniversary by hosting a formal recognition event. The celebration must recognize the Chapter's Founding Sisters, acknowledge the history and establishment of the Chapter, and recognize the contributions and accomplishments of current Chapter members. At minimum, the following awards must be presented: Sister of the Year, Most Improved Sister, Most Inspirational Sister. The anniversary celebration may be conducted as a standalone event or in conjunction with the Chapter Formal or Parents' & Families' Banquet, provided all required recognition components are clearly included.

If the Chapter's official establishment anniversary occurs during the Summer term, the celebration may be held during the Summer and be applied toward the following academic year's Chapter



Standards requirements.

Documentation: Use the official Event Report form, signed by the event Chair. If this event is done in combination with the Chapter Formal or Parents' & Families' Banquet, this must be clearly stated on the Event Report form.

- 4. Probation & Suspension [Required].** The Chapter must report all members placed on Probation or Suspension as a result of a formal Chapter judicial review process. Only disciplinary actions resulting from an official judicial review, conducted in accordance with our governing documents, are required to be reported. Informal warnings, corrective conversations, academic mentorship placement, or minor sanctions not resulting from a judicial review are not reportable under this section. Members placed on Academic Probation by the University are not required to be listed unless the Chapter conducts a separate judicial review and imposes Chapter-level discipline. The National Vice President of Parliament must be notified via email within seven (7) calendar days of the Chapter's final judicial decision.

Documentation: Use the official Probation & Suspension spreadsheet, signed by the Chapter Sergeant at Arms. The National Vice President of Parliament must also verify that they received notification of the probation or suspension of any member immediately following the Chapter's decision.

If no members were placed on Probation or Suspension as a result of a formal judicial review, the Chapter must submit a signed letter on official Sigma Omega Nu letterhead. The letter must state that no judicial reviews resulted in Probation or Suspension during the academic year and be signed by the Chapter Sergeant at Arms.

- 5. Substance Abuse Awareness [Required].** All Active Chapter members must attend some sort of drug and/or alcohol abuse & awareness presentation each year. Examples include attending an Alcoholics/Narcotics Anonymous meeting, a presentation by University Health Services, or presentation by Greek Life. Presentations required by Greek Life for new members count for those new members only; the remaining Chapter members must attend some other presentation.

Documentation: Use the official Event Report form. Form must be signed by the presenter, not a Chapter officer.

- 6. Sexual Assault Awareness [Required].** All Active Chapter members must attend or host at minimum one sexual assault awareness education presentation, workshop, or event during each quarter or semester. Examples include workshops that cover sexual harassment, sexual assault/violence, consent, and bystander intervention. Presentations required by Greek Life and/or the University may count towards the requirement.

If the Chapter chooses to host its own sexual assault awareness event, the event must be conducted in partnership with an established sexual assault prevention or survivor advocacy organization. Qualifying partners may include, but are not limited to: a campus Title IX Office, a Sexual Assault Response or Prevention Center, a Women's Center, a recognized survivor advocacy nonprofit organization, or a certified prevention educator. The partnering organization must have a substantive role in the development and/or facilitation of the program.

Documentation: Use the official Event Report form. Form must be signed by the presenter, not a Chapter officer.

7. **Chapter Retreat [Required].** Each Chapter must host one Chapter Retreat per academic year. The retreat must be open to all membership, consist of a minimum of twelve total hours, include structured bonding activities, and include structured planning sessions for the upcoming academic term and/or academic year. The required twelve hours may be held in a single day or divided across multiple consecutive days but must occur within the same retreat program. A purely social gathering does not satisfy this requirement. Only one retreat per academic year may be counted towards this requirement.

At minimum 80% of Active members, or no fewer than five (5) members (whichever is greater), must attend.

Documentation: Submit the official Event Report form, signed by the Commissioner of Cultura and Sisterhood. In addition, include a copy of the retreat's minutes and outline of programming.

8. **Chapter Meeting Attendance [Expected].** A quorum of two-thirds (66%) of Active Membership is required at all meetings for the efficient running of sorority business. Though two thirds attendance at all meeting is all that is required to meet this credit, it is highly encouraged that all 17 Chapter officers attend every meeting.

Documentation: Use the official General Meeting Attendance spreadsheet, signed by the Chapter Sergeant at Arms.

9. **Sisterhood Social [Expected].** The Chapter is encouraged to host at minimum one Sisterhood Social per quarter/semester. A Sisterhood Social is defined as a Chapter-sponsored event intended to promote bonding, relationship-building, and positive engagement among members. The event must be primarily social in nature and not solely business-related. At minimum 60% of Active members must attend for the event to qualify toward this credit. Only one Sisterhood Social per quarter or semester may be counted toward this credit.

Documentation: Use the official Event Report form for each social, signed by the Commissioner of Cultura and Sisterhood.

10. **Sister of the Month [Expected].** The Chapter is encouraged to recognize one Sister of the Month during each month of the academic year. Months during which the Chapter is not in session (i.e., December, January, June, or other official academic breaks) are not monitored months. For those months, the Chapter must indicate "N/A" in its reporting.

Documentation: Use the official Sister of the Month spreadsheet signed by the Commissioner of Cultura and Sisterhood. For months not monitored due to academic breaks, the Chapter must clearly indicate "N/A" rather than leaving the month blank.

11. **CPR & First Aid [Additional].** It is highly encouraged that members of the Pledge Committee and/or are CPR and First Aid certified. A minimum of 4 certified members are required to meet this

credit.

Documentation: Use the official CPR & First Aid Certification spreadsheet, signed by the Chapter Sergeant at Arms. For each member listed, please include a copy of their certificate.

## **Section E. New Member Education**

If a Chapter is placed on Suspension by the National Board or otherwise prohibited from conducting intake during an academic term, all New Member Education requirements under this Section will be deemed inapplicable for that term. The Chapter will not receive credit or points for any items under this Section during the period of suspension. Once intake privileges are restored, all applicable New Member Education requirements will resume during the next approved intake cycle.

- 1. Pledge Mother Contracts [Obligatory].** During the annual National Conference, all Pledge Mother(s) will be required to sign a Pledge Mother Contract in order to be permitted to pledge a new class during the Fall Quarter/Semester. For classes that begin pledging during Winter Quarter or Spring Semester, the Pledge Mother(s) must submit their Pledge Mother Contracts to the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs a minimum of one month prior to the Pinning ceremony. If the Chapter chooses not to pledge for any reason, the Chapter President must notify the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs of this decision.

Documentation: Verification will be provided by the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs. Nothing is required to be submitted by the Chapter.

- 2. New Member Retreat [Obligatory].** A minimum of 80% of enrolled New Members are required to attend the Annual New Member Retreat. New Members who have graduated are not required to attend. If a Letter of Excuse is submitted by the Chapter and passed by the National Board, the Chapter will not receive points for this credit, but will not be automatically placed on Suspension.

Documentation: Verification will be provided by the National Vice President of Parliament. Nothing is required to be submitted by the Chapter.

- 3. Pledgeship Review Workshop [Required].** Prior to the Pinning of a new class, a separate and dedicated pledgeship review workshop will be required for all Chapter members, regardless of status. The Chapter President and Pledge Mother(s) must run the workshop. During this workshop, all members must read through the entire Standardized Pledgeship document. A brief summary provided by the President during a Chapter General Meeting is not sufficient.

Documentation: Use the official Event Report form, signed by the Chapter President.

- 4. New Pledge Class Induction [Required].** Prior to Pinning a new class, the Pledge Mother(s) must submit the New Pledge Class Induction Form to the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs prior to the Pinning Ceremony.

Documentation: Verification will be provided by the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs. Nothing is required to be submitted by the Chapter

- 5. New Member Initiation [Required].** Prior to the Crossover Ceremony, the Pledge Mother(s) must

submit the New Member Initiation Form to the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs.

Documentation: Verification will be provided by the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs. Nothing is required to be submitted by the Chapter.

- 6. Post Pledgeship Workshops [Required].** Following Crossover, the Pledge Mother(s) must organize a series of Post-Pledgeship Workshops for the new members. At minimum, this must include a review of the Bylaws, Standing Rules, Standardized Pledgeship, Chapter Standards and Code of Ethics. Additionally, the Pledge Mother(s) must inform the new members of any events currently in the planning stages or any upcoming events or activities. See Standardized Pledgeship for more information.

Documentation: Use the official Event Report form, signed by at minimum one Pledge Mother.

## **Section F. Leadership**

- 1. National Council Meetings [Obligatory].** Each Chapter must send one official representative to each National Council Meeting. To satisfy this requirement, the designated representative must be present for the duration of each required meeting. Attendance at all National Council Meetings is mandatory to receive credit. A Letter of Excuse may be submitted by the Chapter and voted by the National Board. If approved, the Chapter will not receive points for this credit, but will not be automatically placed on Suspension.

Documentation: Verification will be provided by the National Vice President of Parliament. Nothing is required to be submitted by the Chapter.

- 2. National Conference [Obligatory].** All Executive Board members and Pledge Mothers are required to attend the annual National Conference. If executive members and/or pledge mothers are not able to attend, they must assign an individual proxy who will represent them at the conference. A list must be submitted to the National Vice President of Parliament outlining who the attendees are and what position they are representing.

If this standard is not met with either the members holding the position or proxies, a Letter of Excuse must be submitted by the Chapter and voted by the National Board. The Chapter will not receive points for this credit, but will not be automatically placed on Suspension.

Documentation: Verification will be provided by the National Vice President of Parliament. Nothing is required to be submitted by the Chapter.

- 3. Executive Retreat [Obligatory].** Each Chapter must send their President and Vice President to the Annual Executive Retreat. Allowable proxies: Elected National Board Representative, or a member of the Chapter's Executive Board.

Documentation: Verification will be provided by the National Vice President of Parliament. Nothing is required to be submitted by the Chapter.

- 4. Officer Transition Meetings [Required].** Following annual Chapter elections and no later than

June 30th of each year, the Chapter must complete a formal Officer Transition Process. The transition process must consist of individual position to position meetings between each outgoing officer and their corresponding incoming officer. Each transition meeting must include at minimum: review of duties and responsibilities, transfer of all official materials (files, passwords, binders, financial records, etc.), review of Chapter Standards and outstanding obligations, and discussion of goals/priorities for the upcoming academic year. All transition meetings must be completed before July 1st.

Documentation: Upon completion of all required officer transition meetings, the Chapter must submit a letter on official Sigma Omega Nu letterhead. The letter must list each outgoing and incoming officer, include the date of each transition meeting, certify that duties, responsibilities, and governing documents were reviewed, certify that all official materials were transferred, and confirm that all transition meetings were completed prior to July 1st. The letter must be signed by the Chapter President, the outgoing Executive Board members and the incoming Executive Board members.

5. **Annual Strategic Plan [Required].** By September 15th, each Chapter must develop and adopt an Annual Strategic Plan for the upcoming academic year. The Annual Strategic Plan must include: 3-5 measurable Chapter-wide strategic priorities for the academic year; specific, measurable goals aligned with those priorities; identified responsible officer(s) for each goal; and target completion timelines. The plan must address, at minimum: membership development, academic excellence, community service/philanthropy, and chapter operations or financial stability. Quarter or semester action steps may be included but must align with the broader annual priorities.

No later than January 31st, the Chapter must submit a written Strategic Plan Progress Report. The report must assess progress toward each annual goal; identify goals completed, in progress, or at risk; provide measurable updates; and outline any adjustments for the remainder of the academic year.

Documentation: No later than September 15, the Chapter must submit the Annual Strategic Plan on official Sigma Omega Nu letterhead, signed by the Chapter President, via email to the National President. No later than January 31, the Chapter must submit the Strategic Plan Progress Report, signed by the Chapter President, via email to the National President. For Chapter Standards reporting purposes, copies of both the Annual Strategic Plan and the Strategic Plan Progress Report must be included in the Chapter's submission materials. Verification of timely submission will be provided by the National President.

6. **Individual Leadership Position, Greek Related [Additional].** Additional points will be awarded for members holding an officer position in a Greek related organization outside of the Chapter. This included positions on the Greek Council, GAMMA, Order of Omega, Philanthropic Council, etc.

Documentation: Provide a list of members and the officer positions held on Official Letterhead. Five points will be given for each position held, not to exceed 20 points.

7. **Individual Leadership Position, Non-Greek Related [Additional].** Additional points will be awarded for members holding an officer position in a non-Greek related campus organization. This included positions on student advisory boards, college representatives, student government, non-Greek clubs, etc. Orientation leaders or resident advisors do not count unless you hold an office on

the associated board.

Documentation: Provide a list of members and the officer positions held on Official Letterhead. Five points will be given for each position held, not to exceed 20 points.

## **Section G. Finances**

See the file “Finances.xls” for the spreadsheets referenced in this section.

- 1. Chapter Dues [Obligatory].** The Chapter paid Chapter dues to National Board by October 15th. Additionally, new member dues were paid by the identified deadline.

Documentation: Verification will be provided by the National Vice President of Finance. Nothing is required to be submitted by the Chapter.

- 2. Financial Audit [Obligatory].** The Chapter submitted a copy of the Chapter’s Financial Book by January 1st.

Documentation: Verification will be provided by the National Vice President of Finance. Include in your binder a print out of the tab labeled “Summary” from the previous calendar year’s Financial Book.

- 3. Member Accounts [Required].** The Chapter Treasurer has on file accurate and up to date records of each member’s account. Dues, fines and payments are clearly noted. Those on contract payments should be consistently making payments.

Documentation: Use the official Member Account Balances spreadsheet. One sheet must be used for each quarter or semester. Summer quarter/semester is not required. Each sheet must be signed by the Chapter Treasurer.

- 4. Chapter Account [Required].** The Chapter has a functioning account, either on campus or at an off campus financial institution.

Documentation: Use the official Chapter Accounts spreadsheet, signed by the Chapter Treasurer. Use account balances as of June of this year.

- 5. Budgeting [Required].** Budgets are submitted, reviewed and approved by the Chapter prior to issuing money or reimbursements. All budgets and corresponding receipts are kept on file. Reimbursements and income must be noted on all final budgets.

Documentation: Provide a copy of both the tentative and final budget for one of the Chapter’s medium to large events. Both must be signed by the Chapter Auditor. Do not submit the original copies nor the receipts.

- 6. Expense Reports [Required].** The Chapter Auditor creates projected expense reports identifying all anticipated costs for each quarter/semester as well as the entire academic year. After each quarter/semester and at the end of the academic year, she will create an actual expense report identifying actual amounts spent compared to projected and approved amounts spent.

Documentation: Provide a copy of the projected and actual expense reports for each quarter/semester as well as the projected and actual expense reports for the entire academic year. All reports must be signed by the Chapter Auditor.

## **Section H. External Relations**

- 1. Inter-Chapter Support [Required].** A minimum of one-half (50%) of the Active Membership of the Chapter must attend an alcohol-free event hosted by another Chapter of Sigma Omega Nu. Examples include fundraisers, community service, Greek council events, pinning or crossover. National Board events hosted at a particular Chapter do not count. The Crossover Ceremony of a new Chapter does count.

Documentation: Use the official Event Report form. A minimum of one photo with all Chapter members in attendance must be submitted.

- 2. Alumnae Relations [Expected].** The Chapter must provide written updates to alumnae no fewer than two times per academic term. Updates must be distributed via email or formal newsletter. Social media posts do not fulfill this requirement. Updates must include, at minimum: past chapter events, academic and community service highlights, pledgship updates (if applicable), member achievements, and upcoming events or engagement opportunities.

Documentation: Provide a copy of each email or newsletter. If it is a newsletter, provide no more than 4 pages.

- 3. Alumnae Event [Expected].** The Chapter must organize a minimum of one Alumnae Event per academic year. This event must be for the specific purpose of bringing together Alumnae and Chapter Actives. Examples include an alumnae dinner, alumnae activities during the Chapter Anniversary celebration or alumnae picnic. Inviting alumnae to a Chapter event does not count. A Chapter is exempt from this requirement if the Chapter has five or fewer Alumnae.

The Chapter must demonstrate documented outreach to all alumnae at minimum four weeks prior to the event. A minimum of 50% of Active Members must be in attendance for the event to qualify toward this requirement.

Documentation: Submit the official Event Report form, signed by the Commissioner of Alumnae Relations. The Chapter must also submit documentation of outreach efforts to Alumnae, which may include copies of emails, invitations, digital flyers, or other written communications demonstrating reasonable efforts to notify all Alumnae with current contact information on file. If the Chapter has five or fewer Alumnae, provide a letter on Sigma Omega Nu Official Letterhead stating so.

- 4. Chapter Website [Expected].** The Chapter must maintain an active, publicly accessible website separate from social media platforms. The website must be reviewed and updated at minimum once per academic term. Social media platforms do not satisfy this requirement.

Documentation: Provide a copy of the home page with the website URL visible.

5. **Chapter Branding & Digital Presence [Additional]**. The Chapter may earn additional points for maintaining an active and professional digital presence that promotes Sigma Omega Nu and chapter activities. Examples may include: consistently updated social media, a digital interest form linked in public platforms, branded content templates, online initiatives connected to our objectives, and/or a Linktree or consolidated resource page.

Documentation: Provide copies or screenshots of qualifying materials. Each distinct example will receive 5 points, not to exceed 20 points total.

6. **Inter-Chapter Collaboration [Additional]**. Points will be awarded for an alcohol-free event or activity co-hosted by the Chapter and at minimum one other Chapter of Sigma Omega Nu. To qualify, both Chapters must share planning responsibility and at minimum 50% of each participating Chapter's Active Membership must be in attendance. Examples include: community service projects, cultural events, workshops, sisterhood socials. Mandatory National events, do not qualify.

Documentation: Use the official Event Report form, signed by the Commissioner of Social Affairs for each Chapter. A minimum of one photo with all Chapter members in attendance must be submitted. Each event will receive 5 points, not to exceed 20 points total.

7. **Campus & Greek Organizations Relations [Additional]**. Points will be awarded for alcohol-free events or activities that are jointly planned and hosted by the Chapter and at minimum one other recognized campus organization, including Greek-letter or non-Greek organizations. To qualify: the event must involve shared planning responsibility between the Chapter and the partnering organization(s), a minimum of 80% of the Chapter's Active Membership must be in attendance, and the event must be open and promoted as a collaborative initiative. Examples include: community service projects, educational or cultural workshops, campus-wide awareness initiatives, or social/networking events.

Documentation: Use the official Event Report form, signed by the Commissioner of Social Affairs. Each event will receive 5 points, not to exceed 20 points total.

8. **NALFO Day of Service [Additional]**. Points will be awarded for a NALFO Day of Service event hosted by the Chapter or Chapter member (Active/Inactive/Alumna). All NALFO rules and regulations must be followed to receive credit.

Documentation: Use the official Event Report form, signed by a NALFO Officer. Each event will receive five (5) points, not to exceed 20 points total.

9. **Yo Soy NALFO Undergraduate Conference [Additional]**. Points will be awarded for attending the annual Yo Soy NALFO undergraduate conference. NALFO sets limitations as to who may attend (for example, only Chapter Presidents).

Documentation: Use the official Event Report form, signed by a NALFO Officer. Five (5) points will be given per required member in attendance.

## **Section I. Administration**



1. **Report Submittal [Obligatory]**. This report must be received by the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs by June 30th.

Documentation: Besides the electronic binder, nothing is required to be submitted by the Chapter for this credit. Do not include this document in the electronic binder.

2. **Report Format [Required]**. Spreadsheets and forms are labeled with the appropriate Section and Number of the requirement, and all documents are submitted as PDFs. All credits that do not have a designated spreadsheet, form or format are submitted on Official Letterhead.
3. **Signatures [Required]**. All signatures provided must be wet signatures or digital signatures (via an approved document signing tool, i.e., DocuSign, DocHub). Typed names are not acceptable.